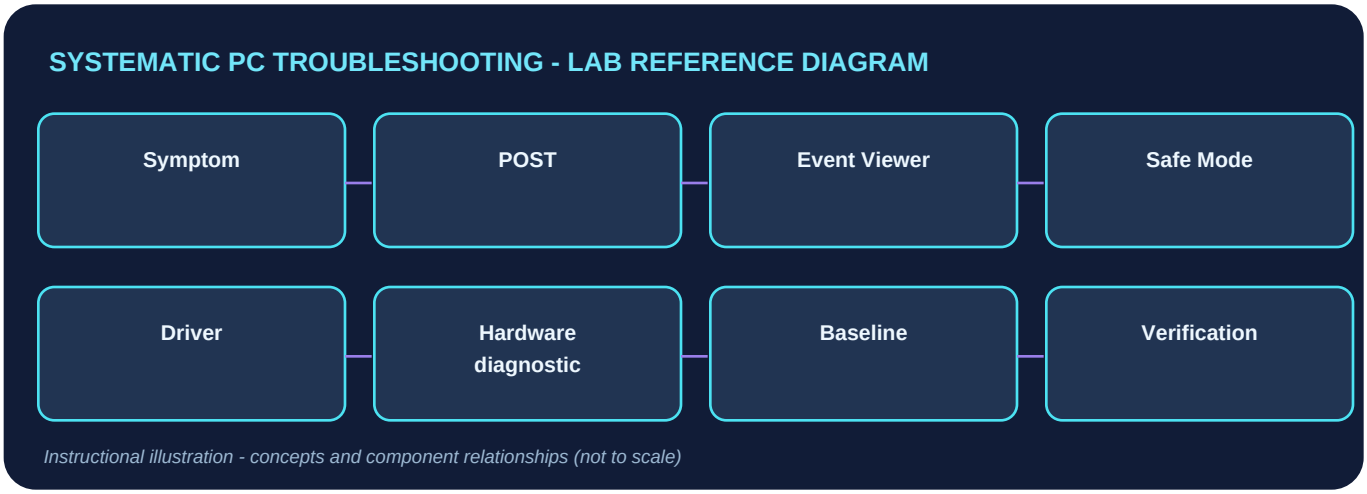
4.5 Troubleshoot a Malfunctioning Computer

STUDENT STUDY GUIDE + VOCABULARY + VISUAL REFERENCE

Learning goal

Solve combined hardware and Windows incidents.

Reference image



Use the labeled illustration to identify the key components, commands, or checkpoints you will encounter in this lab.

Prepare for the simulation

1. Identify the reported symptom and recent changes.
2. Separate hardware from operating-system causes.
3. Test one hypothesis at a time and document results.
4. Verify stable operation and close the work order.

Troubleshooting and safe practice

• Intermittent faults: examine logs and environment.

• Multiple symptoms: isolate a common power or driver cause.

4.5 | VOCABULARY & REVIEW

Essential vocabulary

Term	Meaning / recognition cue
Symptom	A key term in systematic pc troubleshooting; identify its purpose, where it is used, and how to verify it.
POST	Power-on self-test; firmware checks essential hardware during startup.
Event Viewer	A key term in systematic pc troubleshooting; identify its purpose, where it is used, and how to verify it.
Safe Mode	A key term in systematic pc troubleshooting; identify its purpose, where it is used, and how to verify it.
Driver	Software enabling the operating system to communicate with hardware.
Hardware diagnostic	Observation or tool used to identify faults and confirm the repair.
Baseline	A key term in systematic pc troubleshooting; identify its purpose, where it is used, and how to verify it.
Verification	A key term in systematic pc troubleshooting; identify its purpose, where it is used, and how to verify it.

Knowledge check - answer in your own words

1. Identify two components or commands in the reference diagram and explain what each does.

2. What should you verify before changing or installing hardware, settings, or files in this lab?

3. Choose one listed failure symptom. What is your first safe diagnostic step?

4. How will you prove the task is complete, rather than merely assuming success?

Lab readiness checklist

[ ] I can identify the labeled reference items. [ ] I understand the safety precautions.

[ ] I can explain the vocabulary. [ ] I can verify and document successful results.

Student: _____ Date: _____